

Mrs Pamela Thomas
Fulbeck
Farlam
Brampton
Cumbria
CA8 1LA

NHS No :478 744 5464
Ref :T2223779

10/01/2026

Contact Centre **0344 811 8118**
Monday – Friday **8:00am – 4:30pm**

Dear **Pamela Thomas**

The following appointment has been made for you to attend as an outpatient at **Hexham General Hospital**:

Clinician : **-.Diabetes Nurse**
On : **Tuesday 10th February 2026 9:00 a.m.**
Specialty : **Diabetes (3070)**
Report to : **Main Outpatients Department**

Ref: Z2DSN701

You may be seen by other members of the Diabetes Team and should be prepared to be in the clinic for up to 2 hours.

If you need to change the date or time, or cancel the appointment, please let us know using the contact details above. It may be possible to change to a telephone or video call.

If you have additional needs, such as different letter formats or an interpreter, please contact us (see the information on the back of this letter) or call 0344 811 8118.

To get the most out of your appointment:

- bring a friend or relative with you if you wish.
- bring a list of all current medication, including alternative and complementary therapies.
- think about any questions you wish to ask and issues you want to discuss.
- we will offer you a copy of your clinic letter, but if you prefer, make your own notes.

If you cannot attend the appointment, please let us know as soon as possible so we can offer it to someone else. **Each missed appointment costs the NHS £177. So far this year, over 30,000 appointments have been missed, costing the trust almost £5 million.** If you do not attend, we may not offer you another appointment, and you will be referred back to your GP. Please read the important information on the back of this letter.

Yours sincerely
Patient Care Advisor
Contact Centre

Patient transport

Transport to and from hospital can be arranged if required on medical grounds by contacting the Patient Transport Service for your area. If you live in Northumberland, North Tyneside, South Tyneside, Newcastle or Gateshead, ring **0191 215 1515**. If you live in Cumbria, ring **0800 0323 240**. For all other areas, please contact your GP practice for guidance.

Patient transport is available Monday – Friday (excluding bank holidays) for attendances between 9am and 5pm, up to 30 days prior your appointment date. **Please remember if you change your appointment/admission, you also need to change your patient transport booking.**

Help with travel costs

Did you know you may be able to claim for your travel costs? We can help if you are on benefits or low income. www.northumbria.nhs.uk/travel-costs

Entitlement to free treatment

NHS treatment is only free to those who are ordinarily resident in the UK for reasons of lawful settlement. By attending this appointment you are confirming you are entitled to free NHS treatment. If it transpires that you are not entitled to free NHS treatment, you must pay for it.

Doctors and medical students

Our consultants will be supported in providing your care by postgraduate doctors, student nurses and other clinicians in training. If you would like to discuss their involvement in your care please let the ward manager or clinic nurse know.

Specific communication needs

Our information can be made available in large print, Braille or other formats and languages on request. If you have difficulty using the telephone, you can contact us by email: operation.access@nhct.nhs.uk using your preferred email address. We cannot guarantee the security of personal emails, and we will give you further advice on this. You can also contact us through Type talk or other similar systems. BSL users can access <https://www.interpreterslive.co.uk>.

Appointment/admission reminder calls

We use an automated voice/sms system to remind patients of some appointments and admissions. These calls/messages are sent at seven and one day prior to your appointment and you will be asked to confirm whether you can attend. If you would like to Opt out of this system, please call 0344 811 8118.

It's not okay

Abuse directed at staff will not be tolerated and, if required, we will inform the police.

Feedback

Your feedback is essential to help us provide continually improving and compassionate care. If you would like to share your experience with us, call 0800 013 2064 quoting reference RTF-FFT or leave your views at our website www.patientperspective.org/northumbriaFFT

Information Sheet

If you have received and downloaded this appointment letter online via the Patient Portal, you will not receive a copy of this letter by post.

Patient Portal

We are very excited to announce that a brand-new Patient Portal delivered in partnership with digital health company, DrDoctor is now being implemented within Northumbria Healthcare Foundation Trust. This aims to improve how we communicate with patients and reduce our environmental impact.

We will send you reminders by email and SMS text. You can also personalise how you receive information from us. If we have your mobile log onto the Portal at drdoctor.thirdparty.nhs.uk and update your preferences in the settings menu by selecting either email or text reminders. If you do not have access to the internet or a phone you will receive a printed copy of your hospital appointment letter. You can also reply STOP to any message that you receive, which will end text and email message reminders.

If you still wish to receive your letters in the post, you can opt to do so via the patient portal.

Telephone Appointments –Wherever appropriate, we will arrange a telephone appointment with one of our clinical team, rather than bring patients into a hospital. It is important that we have your correct telephone number recorded so if you have changed your number recently, please let us know. We would also ask that you are available for 30 minutes either side of your telephone appointment time. Please be aware that the number we call you from could show as 'withheld' on your phone display.

Online Appointments (Dr Doctor) – We may also offer online appointments for some services which use a system called DrDoctor. Further information regarding online appointments can be found on our website www.northumbria.nhs.uk

There will be occasions where the only appropriate option is to see patients in person in a hospital outpatient department. In these circumstances, we have implemented changes to keep you and our staff as safe as possible.

Coming into Hospital - keeping you and our staff safe

Patients should aim to attend hospital appointments when they are well enough to do so. If you feel unwell and cannot come for any reason, please contact us in advance to rearrange your appointment. If you test positive for COVID19, you are still welcome to attend your appointment as long as you feel well enough. We do ask that you wash your hands and wear a face mask before you enter and leave the hospital.

Help with travel costs

Did you know you may be able to claim for your travel costs?

You must meet the following criteria:

- You or your partner must be receiving one of the [qualifying benefits](#) or be eligible for the [NHS Low Income Scheme](#)
 - Others eligible include:
 - Dependents (children) of those receiving one of the qualifying benefits
 - Those living in a care home / accommodation provided by the local authority
 - Asylum seekers receiving government support
 - Young people aged 16 and 17 supported by the local authority
- You must have an appointment that a [doctor or dentist has referred you to](#)
- Your appointment must be on a separate visit to when the referral was made

You can claim when you are at your appointment at most of our hospitals. There is also an online and paper form option.

For more information about how to apply, visit www.northumbria.nhs.uk/travel-costs or call 0191 203 1535.

Great North Care Record

To further improve patient care, your patient information is shared with the Great North Care Record. You can find more details about this and how your information is securely stored in the Great North Care Record at <https://www.greatnorthcarerecord.org.uk/patients/> or by calling 0344 811 9587.

Privacy Notice

To understand how we use your personal information please see our privacy notice at <https://www.northumbria.nhs.uk/privacy-notice>

***Please note: Our Contact Centre opening phone hours are changing from 15th January 2025 to 08.00am-04.30pm. We apologise for any inconvenience this may cause.